

To which I replied: "Madam, if you will read any of my books in the spirit in which I wrote them, you will find Jesus on every page—between the lines, however, not in the words that are printed."

Self-control gives you strength. To be yourself, practice self-control. Few people have difficulty in controlling their physical actions, but they may never stop to realize that physical actions begin in the mind. A man whose mind conceives only a small, frightened view of life will *act* just like a man whose mind conceives only a small, frightened view of life.

A person who has self-control has strength—I repeat, *strength*—denied to many another. Above all, he has the strength to see situations clearly, judge them for what they really are, greatly increase the percentage of life-situations he swings toward his own good and the good of others.

Please look back at the list of forty-three items earlier in this chapter. Number 22 says that a person who is his own master never seeks revenge on anyone. Let us take this as a very good example. Revenge can be spuriously sweet, but it is a sweet poison to the personality and no more will merge with peace of mind than oil will merge with water.

Who is in a better position to revenge himself on a person who has hurt him, but seeks an appointment to public office, than the President of the United States? Very well, let us look at one of our Presidents—first some five years before he attained that high office.

When I mention he was then a lawyer in Springfield, Illinois, you will have no trouble in identifying Abraham Lincoln. One of our earliest big industrial companies was in legal difficulty, and Lincoln was appointed by the court to work with two other lawyers on the case. But these two lawyers were famous big-city men. They snubbed the gawky country lawyer. When he painstakingly prepared papers on the case, they would not even read them.

Worse yet, they would not even sit at the same table with him. This was a public humiliation, and it must have hurt bitterly.

Five years passed. The lean, sad-faced man was elected President. Soon it was time for him to choose his cabinet, including a Secretary of War. One man stood out as the best choice for this ominously important post—Edward M. Stanton. And Lincoln remembered Stanton as one of the lawyers who had treated him so badly in his Springfield days.